

Delaware County Council Meeting December 17th 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VmgPv7vXIOM
Publication Date	2024-12-17T16:27:02Z
Target Category	delaware_county

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: December 17, 2024

Body: Delaware County Council

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** Statutory Public Hearing [00:01:10](#) regarding the establishment of an Economic Revitalization Area (ERA) for Midwest Metal Products to accommodate a tax abatement.
- **Summary of Discussion:** Chad Smith, CFO of Midwest Metal Products, testified that the company is purchasing two mesh welders (replacing an older one and adding capacity to grow with current customers) and an LVD press brake to replace a 20-year-old unit. Proof of proper legal notice in *The Star Press* (December 6) and notification letters to adjoining landowners were entered into the record. The public hearing was subsequently closed [00:03:01](#).

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer (President Piper) called the meeting to order at [00:00:25](#).

- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Webb, Mr. Langan, Mr. Menzie, Mr. Hughes, Mr. Weidner, Mr. Spangler, President Piper, and Mr. Freeman (full roster present).
 - **Members Absent:** None.
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Piper.
-

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening prayer/statement followed by the Pledge of Allegiance led by Mr. Piper 00:00:28.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** The November 26, 2024 County Council meeting minutes were approved via roll call vote (Passed Unanimously / Mr. Langan abstained due to absence) 00:03:46.
-

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:04:35 County General (EMS - 155):** Transfer of funds to cover an operating supplies fuel deficit and equipment/vehicle maintenance lines.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Department representatives / Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding covering year-end utility/fuel shortfalls.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 00:05:17.
- **00:05:35 Public Defender (139):** Reallocation of attorney salaries, chief public defender lines, and funding adjustments (8-cent rounding book balances due to double-pay corrections and payroll reconciliation).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Public Defender / Auditor's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed an erroneous double payment where one attorney repaid funds and another had their final paycheck withheld. Auditor explained zero-balance 8-cent adjustments. Noted an anticipated \$30,000<U+2013>\$40,000 year-end fund return.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 00:08:16.
- **00:08:39 Jail & Sheriff Budgets (145):** Transfers for part-time, correctional officer salaries, overtime, food/lodging operating supplies, and equipment repairs.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail / Sheriff administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Covered final inmate feeding bills and repairs before year-end. Noted an expected return of approximately \$62,000 in unused fuel funds due to dropping fuel prices.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 00:11:07.
- **00:11:24 Courts (138):** Transfer of \$3,000 from assistant court reporter salary line to other services and charges.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Covered late-arriving jury trial expenses, psychological evaluation fees, and interpreter fees. Noted an expected return of roughly \$15,200 from salary lines.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 00:12:36.
- **00:12:52 Auditor's Office (126):** Adjustments across finance deputy, chief deputy, tax sale deputy, overtime, part-time, FICA, and PERF lines.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tanya Dunmore, Chief Deputy Auditor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Extensive debate over FLSA rule changes from July 2024 (mandating overtime eligibility for certain salaried employees under specific thresholds) and subsequent federal court rulings in November 2024 striking down the rule. Discussion centered on whether to pay accrued overtime for hours worked under the active federal rule prior to its judicial vacation.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Amended to adjust numbers and approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 00:43:36.
- **00:44:20 Project Income (Drug/Mental Health Grants):** Transfers involving peer recovery coach, case management supervisor, health insurance, PERF, and FICA.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Grant administrators.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reallocating grant funds and health insurance lines to close out the year safely.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 00:45:34.
- **00:45:52 Local Public Health Services & Board of Health (1161 / 1159):** Adjustments for environmental administrator salaries, PERF, health insurance, part-time, and overtime.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jamie Bane, Health Department Administrator.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed vacancy savings reallocated to insurance/PERF shortfalls, and paying out comp time for an employee shifting from non-exempt to exempt under new classifications.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 00:47:21 and 00:48:15.
- **00:48:31 EMS Addendum (155):** Adjustments for Advanced EMTs and Paramedics due to mid-year promotions.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Megan (EMS).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adjusted lines to match actual promotional pay increases for staff advancing from Basic to Advanced EMT.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 00:50:50.
- **00:51:08 Treasurer's Office (127):** Transfer from Professional Services to Chief Deputy salary/overtime lines.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Treasurer's Office / Kathy Butterfield.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed FLSA-related overtime compensation for the Chief Deputy. Motion successfully amended to establish a dedicated overtime line (-126) for auditing transparency.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Amended and Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 00:53:21.
- **00:53:35 Communications / 911 (124):** Transfer of \$7,000 from Communications Technician salary to PERF.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred (Communications Director).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed a shortfall in PERF obligations despite departmental vacancies.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 01:00:49.
- **[00:1:08] Commissioners (153):** Transfer from part-time to HR Assistant salary line.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sarah (representing Commissioners).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed a bi-weekly calculation error from 2023/2024 resulting in a minor overpayment to an HR employee. Council agreed to fund the final paycheck to prevent zero-pay, deferring payback discussions to January.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 01:05:34.
- **01:11:52 CASA Grant (1212):** Transfer of \$30 from office supplies to books and other media.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ashley Soldak, CASA Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Covered a subscription rate hike for *The Star Press* investigative tool.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 01:12:43.
- **01:12:50 LIT Jail & LIT Sheriff Budgets (11701 / 11719):** Salary and insurance reallocations.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff's Office / Auditor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Year-end cleanup of health and disability insurance lines.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 01:14:19.
- **01:15:17 Resolution 2024-21: Midwest Metal Products ERA Designation:** Confirming an Economic Revitalization Area.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Bill (Tax Abatement Committee).

- **Deliberation Summary:** Committee unanimously recommended approval. Mr. Webb abstained due to a familial conflict of interest (spouse employed by Midwest Metal).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously among voting members, Mr. Webb abstaining) 01:17:37.
- 01:17:47 **Resolution 2024-22: Midwest Metal Products Tax Abatement:** Approving the tax abatement agreement.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Bill (Tax Abatement Committee).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Companion resolution to the ERA designation.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Mr. Weidner abstained; all other present members voted Yes) 01:18:12.
- 01:18:25 **2025 Board Appointments & Elections:**
 - **Alcohol Beverage Board:** Doug Hutchinson reappointed. (Passed Unanimously 01:19:12)
 - **Board of Health:** Elise Burks appointed. (Passed Unanimously 01:19:39)
 - **Council Attorney:** Beasley & Gilkinson retained. (Passed Unanimously 01:20:02)
 - **Daleville Economic Development Commission:** Brent Chetam retained. (Passed Unanimously 01:20:28)
 - **** Drainage Advisory Board:**** Matt Menzie appointed. (Chair pick / No roll call required).
 - **Housing Authority (Resident Member):** Patricia Roor retained. Republican seat held over to January 2nd for candidate recruitment. (Passed Unanimously 01:22:46)
 - **Property Tax Assessment Board of Appeals (PTABOA):** Carrie Wigly reappointed. (Passed Unanimously 01:23:51)
 - **Redevelopment Commission (Two seats):** Amber green and Rob Keasling reappointed after debate emphasizing their active oversight and questioning of economic development spending. (Passed Unanimously for selected slate) 01:31:58.
 - **Tax Abatement Committee:** Current slate (Joe and Josh) reappointed. (Passed Unanimously 01:33:30).
 - **Yorktown Economic Development:** Dan Flanigan reappointed. (Passed Unanimously / Mr. Flanigan abstained) 01:34:28.
- 01:37:55 **Ordinances 2024-26 & 2024-27 (Longevity Experience Pay / Do Pay Ordinances):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Eugene / Auditor's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Auditor review necessitated amending the previously adopted longevity pay ordinances to explicitly name the newly created funds and include blank fields for fund numbers.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Rules suspended, amendments approved, and ordinances finally adopted by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 01:43:08 and

01:49:34.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **02:03:34 Christopher Bilbury:** Spoke to congratulate and thank outgoing Councilmember Ryan Webb for his rigorous questioning and holding departments accountable. Warned against viewing local government as a popularity contest and urged incoming council members to maintain high transparency standards and scrutinize potential conflicts of interest.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Brad Hunt (Auditor's Office) provided a year-end interest earnings update, noting total interest earned at approximately \$3.47M (including ARP interest), projecting roughly \$3.18M without ARP. Raised concerns over the Commissioners attempting to claim ARP interest funds.
 - Amanda Green (County Coroner) provided a 2024 year-end recap, reporting 666 coroner calls, 201 autopsies, and an anticipated \$10,000 budget return.
 - Jamie Bane (Health Department), Ed (Auditor's Office), and several council members offered farewell remarks and praise to outgoing Councilmember Ryan Webb for his four years of service, emphasis on fiscal transparency, and rigorous oversight.
- **Next Meeting Dates:** Reorganization meeting scheduled for Thursday, January 2, 2025, at 9:00 AM; next regular meeting scheduled for Tuesday, January 28, 2025, at 9:00 AM.
- **Adjournment:** Officially adjourned by voice/roll call vote (Passed Unanimously)
01:15:35.

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-10-01 02:01:26 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.